# Seiwoong Hong

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## Education

**The Ohio State University, Fisher College of Business**
Ph.D. in Finance, 2021 - Present (Expected May 2027)

**Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)**
M.S. in Management Engineering (Finance), 2019 - 2021
B.S. in Mathematical Science, 2012 - 2019 (including two years of mandated military service)

## Research Areas

Corporate Finance, Innovation, and Entrepreneurial Finance

## Working Papers

### How Do Firms Respond to Patent Grants to Related Firms? *(Job market paper)*


*Abstract:* When a firm is granted a patent, its technologically related peers can gain from the disclosed knowledge or lose from the patentee's stronger exclusion rights. I show that stock market reactions on the grant date tell these cases apart and predict how peers reallocate their innovative efforts. Instrumenting grants with patent examiner leniency, I find that granting a patent on an important innovation raises R&D expenses and acquisitions among technologically close peers and shifts the patenting of close product-market rivals toward new technologies, while the average response to other grants is not statistically distinguishable from zero. When the stock prices of both the patentee and the peer rise significantly around the grant date, the peer raises R&D by about 7% and its acquisition probability by 6 percentage points and directs more of its patenting toward the granted patent's technology; when the peer's stock price falls, it shifts its patenting away from that technology without a statistically significant change in its overall innovative efforts. Equally large joint price movements without a grant do not predict comparable innovation responses. For the average peer whose stock price rises significantly with the patentee's, the estimated R&D response implies an increase of about $21.6 million in R&D spending over the four years after the grant. The responses are concentrated among peers with ample cash, low leverage, and strong absorptive capacity.


- *Award:* Korea-America Finance Association Best Doctoral Dissertation Award (2026)
- *Presentations:* FMA Special PhD Paper Presentations (2026); FMA Doctoral Student Consortium (2026); 22nd Annual Olin Finance Conference at WashU (PhD Session) (2026); The Ohio State University Finance Brownbag Seminar (2026)

### Funding the Uncommon: Financial Incentives and Corporate Investment in Rare Disease Innovation


*Abstract:* Can financial incentives redirect corporate innovation toward socially valuable projects with limited commercial markets? I study the Rare Pediatric Disease Priority Review Voucher program, which provides a transferable financial reward for successful drug development. Using clinical-trial data and a difference-in-differences design, I find that the program increases public-firm participation in eligible drug development, including entry and continued investment in existing projects. The response primarily reflects an expansion of firms' innovation portfolios rather than substitution away from other projects. These findings show that outcome-contingent financial incentives can affect both the level and direction of corporate innovation.

## Work in Progress

**Intangible Capital and the Boundaries of the Firm** *(with René Stulz)*

**Trading the Grid: Financial Traders in Electricity Markets** *(with Dustin Bae, Itzhak Ben-David, and Hyeongjun Kim)*

## Research Experience

**Fisher College of Business (Ohio State University), Columbus, USA** Aug 2021 - Present
***Graduate Research Associate***

- For Professor Kewei Hou — Aug 2021 - May 2022
- For Professor Petra Vokata — May 2022 - Aug 2022
- For Professor Ingrid Werner — Aug 2022 - Jan 2023
- For Professor Tom Meling — Jan 2023 - May 2024, Jan 2025 - May 2025
- For Professor Sergey Sarkisyan — Aug 2024 - Dec 2024
- For Professor Mike Wittry — Aug 2025 - Jan 2026

## Teaching

- Corporate Finance (Undergraduate) — May 2024 – Aug 2024
  Overall Instructor Rating: 4.65/5.00 (University Average: 4.49/5.00)

## Professional Experience

- Referee: Financial Management, Journal of Empirical Finance

## Skills

- Software and Programming: Stata, Python, R, MATLAB, and LaTeX.
- Languages: English (fluent) and Korean (native)

## References

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The Ohio State University
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**Tom Meling**
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The Ohio State University
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**Mike Wittry**
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